

Isaiah C. Johnson

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Appointments

Rice University, Houston, TX 2026-present
Postdoctoral Associate, Department of Political Science
Affiliate: Executive Policy Research Group

Education

Princeton University, Princeton, NJ 2021-2026
MA, Ph.D., Politics
Committee: Ismail White (Chair), LaFleur Stephens-Dougan, Gleason Judd
Dissertation title: “Three Essays on Multiracial Identity, Uncertainty, and Representation”
Fields: American Politics, Race and Ethnic Politics, Formal and Quantitative Methods

University of Houston, Houston, TX 2019-2021
M.A., Political Science

University of Houston, Houston, TX 2017-2019
B.S., Political Science

Publications

Rottinghaus, Brandon and **Isaiah C. Johnson**. 2021. “Presidential ‘Pitches’ and White House Pressure: Inter-Personal Presidential Persuasion in a Shared Lawmaking Environment.” *Presidential Studies Quarterly*.

Working Papers

Stephens-Dougan, LaFleur, Burcu Kolcak, **Isaiah C. Johnson**, Kaiyla Dartey, Jeron Fenton, Jasante’ Howard, and Ismail K. White. “Moving Beyond Linked Fate: A New Measure of Politicized Racial Identity.”

Revise and Resubmit, *Journal of Politics*

Stephens-Dougan, LaFleur, Davin L. Phoenix, Andrea Benjamin, Kaiyla Dartey, and **Isaiah C. Johnson**. “Double Jeopardy: Punitive Responses to Black Women Politicians’ Anger.”

Revise and Resubmit, *Political Behavior*

Johnson, Isaiah C. “Jack of All Trades, Master of Some: Racial Competency and the Limits of Multiracial Representation.”

Under Review

Johnson, Isaiah C. “Multiracial Politicians and Political Representation: An Experimental Study.”

Dartey, Kaiyla and **Isaiah C. Johnson**. “Opening the Gate: Multiracial Identity and Institutional Access in Congressional Primaries ”

Works in Progress

Johnson, Isaiah C. “Measuring Racial Competence with Machine Learning: Evidence from Congressional Committees.”

Johnson, Isaiah C. “Lobbying over Identity: Multiracial Recognition and the Boundaries of Black Solidarity.”

Sasso, Greg, Corrine M. McConnaughey, and **Isaiah C. Johnson**. “The Dynamics of Suffrage.”

Johnson, Isaiah C, Gavin Medina, and Mellissa Meisels. “The Agency of Identity: Minority Candidate Rhetoric in Electoral Context.”

Other Publications

Johnson, Isaiah C. and Guillermo Ortega. 2021. “Diversity and School Boards: An Analysis of Race, Geography, and Education Policy in Houston School Districts.” University of Houston Center for Mexican American Studies.

Grants and Fellowships

Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models Summer Institute (NSF)	2025
Center for the Study of Democratic Politics Behavior Seed Grant (\$400)	2025
Center for the Study of Democratic Politics Graduate Student Research Grant (\$9,400)	2025
Quantitative and Analytical Political Science Fellowship (\$3,000)	2023–2025
Multidisciplinary Multiracial Small Research Grant (\$1,000)	2024
Lab on Politics, Race and Experimental Methods Grant (\$2,000)	2023
Princeton Research in Experimental Social Science Grant (\$1,500)	2022
Center for the Study of Democratic Politics Grant (\$500)	2021
University of Houston Center for Mexican American Studies Fellowship (\$26,250)	2019–2021
University of Houston Political Science Delores Welder Mitchel Grant (\$2,000)	2019–2021
University of Houston Department of Undergraduate Research Travel Grant (\$528)	2019
University of Houston Department of Undergraduate Research Summer Fellowship (\$4,000)	2018

Awards and Honors

Princeton Department of Politics George Kateb Preceptor Award	2025
Princeton President’s Fellowship	2021–2023
University of Houston Dean’s List	2017–2019

Teaching

Princeton University, Preceptor

POL 575: Formal Political Analysis I (Graduate)

Spring 2024, 2025

POL 345: Introduction to Quantitative Social Science

Fall 2024

POL 344: Race and Politics in the United States (Lead Preceptor)

Fall 2023

Presentations

American Political Science Association Meeting	2020, 2024, 2025, 2026
Midwest Political Science Association Meeting	2025
Conference on Identity and Inequality (Poster)	2024, 2026
The Racial Frontier Conference	2023
National Conference of Black Political Scientists	2023, 2026
Symposium on the Politics of Immigration, Race, and Ethnicity	2022
Pi Sigma Alpha National Student Conference	2019

Invited Talks

University of Colorado-Boulder Research on Accountability, Civics, and Equity Lab	2024
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Service

Reviewer

PS: Political Science & Politics, Journal of Politics

Discipline

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2026
Discussant	
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2025
Chair & Discussant	
Princeton University , Conference on Bridging Representation Gaps	2025
Discussant	
Princeton University , Conference on Identity and Inequality	2024
Discussant	
Princeton University , Race and Policy Feedback Conference	2024
Discussant	

Department

Princeton University , Princeton Research in Experimental Social Science	2021 – 2026
Graduate Coordinator	

References

Professor Ismail K. White

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